

# **LYING BODY LANGUAGE**

Many people find it difficult to figure out whether a person is lying or not. If you are facing the same problem, knowing about lying body language will help you in detecting a liar. This article will give you information on how the body language and facial expression of a person changes when he is fabricating the truth.

Lying is something that most of us indulge in some or the other time in our lives. The reason for telling a lie can be different for every person. While some tell a lie to save themselves from getting punished or avoiding embarrassment, some do it to avoid hurting others' feelings. Whatever be the reason for telling a lie, it creates a tension in the person which leads to several changes in his body language. The main reason for changes in body languages and facial expression that occurs when a person lies can be attributed to one's upbringing. Most of us are told by our parents that lying is something bad and are often punished for it too during our growing up years. Hence, when one has to tell a lie during certain circumstances, the mind that has been trained to see lying as a negative behavior often causes stress in a person, making the whole act of telling a lie rather uncomfortable. So when people try to protect themselves from getting caught while lying, they automatically act in a different way than they normally do which actually gives them away. Therefore let us take a look at lying body language and facial expression that will help you in knowing when a person is lying.

## **HOW TO DETECT IF SOMEONE IS LYING**

Before we go into the details of lying body language, it is important to know that these characteristics will apply for normal people and not for someone whom lying comes naturally i.e. people who suffer from some psychological disorder like compulsive lying disorder. Recognizing the signs of a person who is lying will be helpful in various situations as well as relationships, like when a person is lying to his girlfriend, employer, parent, sibling, etc. So, here are some of the body language and lying signs that you will be able to observe when a person is lying.

## **BODY POSTURE**

The first sign you can observe when a person is lying is change in body posture. The stress that is created in the body when a person tells a lie, makes his body stiff and very erect. This is the most obvious sign of lying, if the person had been sitting or standing in a comfortable position before you asked a question which made him uncomfortable. He is also not likely to stand straight, rather you may observe him shifting from one foot to another while lying. In short, there will be a change in his overall body posture from which you can easily recognize that he is feeling uncomfortable.

## **HAND GESTURES**

Another sign of lying is when the person restricts his body as well as his hand movement when talking. People feel that any kind of hand movements can actually make the other person recognize that they are lying and hence, keep their hands in their pockets or maybe hold them tightly to control their movements. However, they do not realize that there is a connection between hand gestures and

lying, and by controlling their hand movements, they are actually creating suspicion in the minds of other people, especially those who use their hand gestures while talking to explain things and incidents.

### **EYE CONTACT**

Just like hand gestures, there is also a strong link between lying body language and eyes. It is a widely known fact that most people while lying try to avoid eye contact with the opposite person. Though this is often true, nowadays the situation has changed because most people know about this and tried to do the opposite to avoid getting caught while lying. Experts say that nowadays, people are likely to make eye contact for a longer time than they normally do while lying and this is also a sign for a longer time than they normally do while lying and this is also a sign that people should look for, while trying to detect whether a person is lying.

- **Self-Touch**

As people keep their hand gestures restricted to themselves while lying, they are said to indulge in self touching too. You may see that the person is constantly touching his face, especially rubbing his nose, chin or ears. Sometimes, people are also said to cover their mouth while telling a lie, however, most people know about it and hence, avoid doing it, these days.

- **Avoidance**

People who are lying may not face you while talking to you. They may turn to the other side in the pretense of doing some work. If you sit beside them, they may get up or shift to another room. In short, they will try to do everything that they can to avoid you. Another sign of lying body languages is changes in smiling frequency. However, this will depend on person to person. While some people actually stop smiling, there are others who may smile too much while telling a lie.

With these tips on lying body language, I hope you will be able to recognize when a person is lying to you. However, one important thing you have to remember is that these changes in body language may not indicate that the person is lying every time, as some of these body patterns will be normal for certain people. Therefore, to detect whether a person is actually lying, knowing the person's normal body language and facial expression is also extremely important.